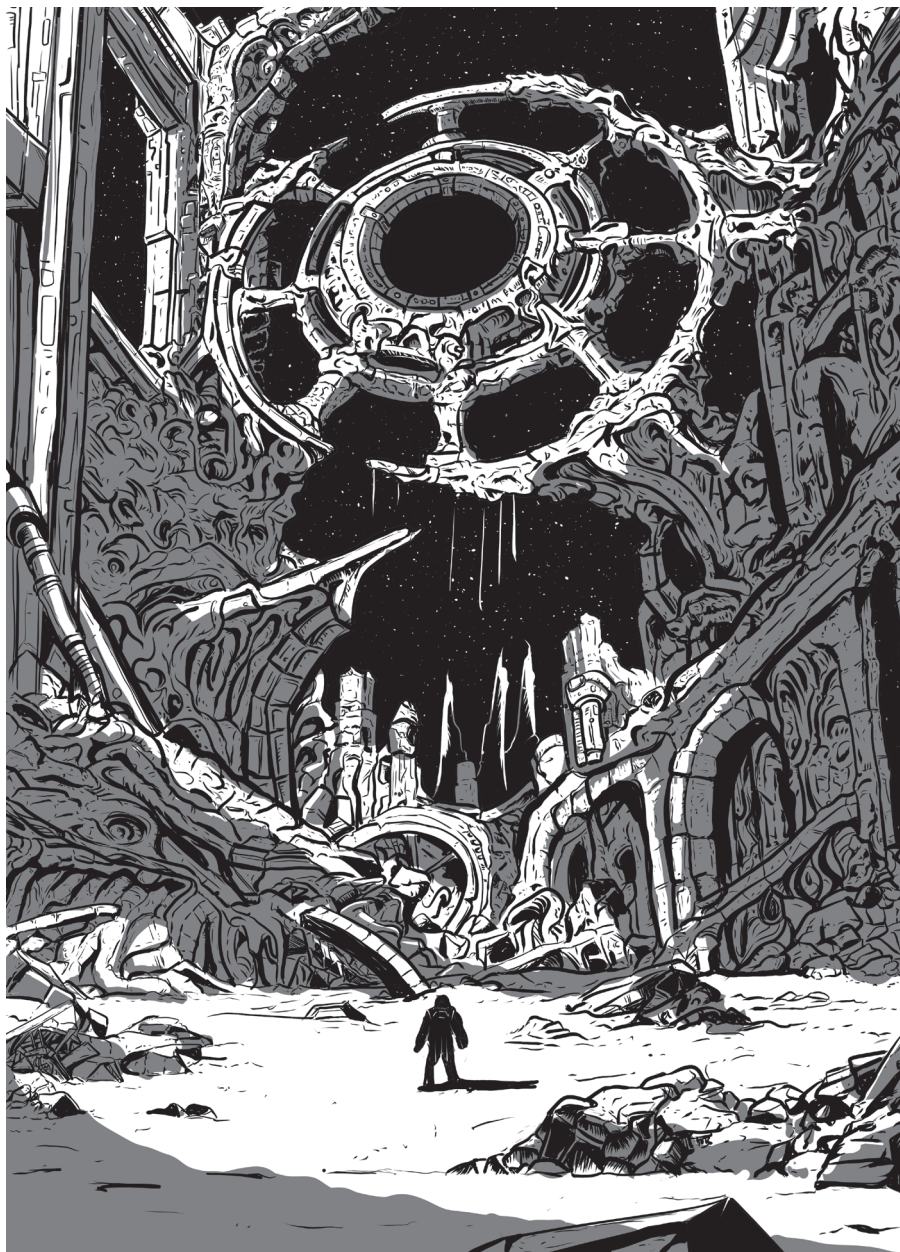




DARKSPACE

Quickstart Rules for Spacers

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ShadowDark RPG



CHARACTER CREATION

DarkSpace is a sci-fi RPG that uses the rules-light SHADOWDARK RPG and requires a copy of those rules to play.

The Shadowdark rulebook along with free Quickstart Rules can be found at:

[**www.thearcanelibrary.com**](http://www.thearcanelibrary.com)

DarkSpace is 100% compatible with Shadowdark. However, there are some slight differences in terminology. These are explained below.

SPACER'S FIRST STEPS

Characters in DarkSpace are called **Spacers**, and can start as either Citizens or Rookies (see following page).

- **Step 1: Generate Spacer Stats.** Use the “3d6 down the line” method described in Shadowdark.
- **Step 2: Determine Species.** Rather than an ancestry, Spacers have a species. (See the **Species section for details.**)
- **Step 3: Choose Archetype.** Classes in DarkSpace are focused more on heroic archetypes and less on profession. As such, they are referred to as Archetypes. (See the **Archetypes section for details.**)
- **Step 4: Define Background.** Spacers have occupations rather than backgrounds. (See the **Backgrounds section for details.**)
- **Step 5: Choose Motivation.** Rather than the classic alignments in Shadowdark, Spacers have motivations instead. (See the **Motivation section for details.**)
- **Step 6: Pick Gear.** Determine starting Credits and pick your starting equipment. (See the **Gear section for details.**)
- **Step 7 (Optional): Ship Role**
 - Titles are not tied to your archetype but your position or rank within your crew. Your Ship Role can change over time. (See **Starfaring in the DarkSpace Core Rules for details.**)

SPECIES

Science fiction is known for its diversity of lifeforms. Every spacer has a species that defines its own genetic traits. Your setting may have many alien species, or it may only have humans.

Humans (or human analogues) have the Ambitious trait as they do in the Shadowdark rulebook.

You may use any Shadowdark ancestries or ancestry traits for your species.

If you would like to use a species from a science fiction property or randomly create one, use the Species Traits table to either roll a species trait at random or choose one.

Collaborate with your GM and fellow players if you are having trouble with building a species from a random trait.

Example 1: Steve wants to play an Elf. He chooses Elf as his species and takes the Farsight ancestry trait from Shadowdark as his species trait.

Example 2: Katie wants to play her own species of triad-sensitive slugs. She chooses The Triad as her species trait and describes what her character, Slurp looks like.

Example 3: Elliott wants to play a sasquatch-person from a movie he watched. He chooses Mighty as his species trait.

Example 4: Bob doesn't know what species to play. He rolls on the Species Traits table and gets Amphibious. He decides to play a race of fish-people he saw in a movie once.

Example 5: Bons doesn't know what species to play but knows they want their character to be a medic. Their fellow players suggest Extra Arms for the species trait as that can help with field medicine. Bons decides on a human with extra cybernetic arms rather than taking the Ambitious trait that humans normally get.

SPECIES TRAITS

d20 Traits

- 1 **The Triad.** You have the use of one Triad power. (see DarkSpace Core Rules)
- 2 **Amphibious.** You can breathe water as well as air. You can swim at full speed.
- 3 **Armored Skin.** Gain +1 to your AC when not wearing armor.
- 4 **Covert Communication.** You can communicate secretly with others of your species or those who understand this communication.
- 5 **Longsight.** You get a +1 bonus to ranged attack and damage rolls.
- 6 **Hyperacute Senses.** You can't be surprised by enemies or events.
- 7 **Powerful.** You have a +1 bonus to melee attack and damage rolls.
- 8 **Natural Weapon.** You have a natural weapon that deals 1d6 damage. You are proficient with it.
- 9 **Flight.** You can fly and/or walk.
- 10 **Sneaky.** You have advantage when trying to be deceptive.
- 11 **Tracking Sense.** Once per day, pick a target to be your quarry. You have advantage on all checks to track your quarry.
- 12 **Adapted for Heat.** Can survive in hot environments. Half damage from fire or heat.
- 13 **Adapted for Cold.** Can survive in cold environments. Half damage from ice or cold.
- 14 **Technical Knack.** You get a +1 bonus when working with technology and machines.
- 15 **Natural Connection.** You get a +1 bonus when working with plants and animals.
- 16 **Radiation Resistant.** Can survive in radioactive environments. Half damage from radiation or electricity.
- 17 **Filtration.** Can survive in toxic environments. Half damage from poison.
- 18 **Natural Climber.** Full speed for climbing. Reduce climbing DC by one category.
- 19 **Extra Arms.** Can take one extra non-attack action per turn. Increase gear slots by 2.
- 20 **Extra Legs.** Can move up to Near twice in a turn in addition to their action. DC to be tripped increased by one category.



STRONG ARCHETYPE

Grunts, teamsters, gladiators, and bodyguards. Strong characters are the muscle that carry the galaxy on their shoulders.

Weapons: All Melee weapons

Armor: All Armor

Hit Points: 1d8 per level.

Heavy Lifter. Your number of gear slots is equal to your STR score (or 10) + STR mod (if positive).

Weapon Expertise. Pick a category of melee weapon, like Blunt Weapons. You get +1 to hit and do damage with that kind of weapon. In addition, add half your level to those rolls (rounded down).

Might. You have advantage on checks to overcome a great feat of strength, such as kicking open a stuck cargo hatch or pulling a robot's arm off.

STRONG TALENTS

2d6	Talent
-----	--------

2	Cleave. Deal an additional +1d4 damage when scoring a critical hit (can be taken multiple times).
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3-6	+1 to melee attacks
-----	---------------------

7-9	+2 to Strength, Dexterity, or Constitution stat
-----	---

10-11	Choose one category of armor. You get +1 AC from that armor.
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12	Choose a Strong Talent or +2 points to assign to stats.
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QUICK ARCHETYPE

Pilots, thieves, gunslingers, and assassins. Quick characters move fast and strike with precision.

Weapons: Melee and Ranged Weapons (excluding Heavy Weapons in both)

Armor: Light Armor

Hit Points: 1d6 per level.

Quick Shot. If a creature doesn't notice your attack, you roll extra weapon dice for damage equal to half your level (rounded up).

Never Tell Me the Odds. Start each game with a Luck Token. After you have finished a rest you gain a Luck Token if you don't already have one.

Reflexes. You have advantage on DEX checks to avoid a dangerous situation, such as avoiding a laser mine or flying through an asteroid field.

QUICK TALENTS

2d6	Talent
-----	--------

2	Trick Shot. 1/day Re-roll a missed ranged attack. If successful, the shot ricochets and hits its target as a Quick Shot. If you already have Trick Shot, you gain an additional use per day.
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3-5	Your Quick Shot deals +1 dice of damage (can be taken multiple times).
-----	--

6-9	+2 to Dexterity, Wisdom or Charisma stat
-----	--

10-11	+1 to ranged attacks
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12	Choose a talent or +2 points to distribute to stats.
----	--



TOUGH ARCHETYPE

Soldiers, bounty hunters, scrappers, and bruisers. Tough characters are resilient and can survive a long haul.

Weapons: Heavy Melee and Heavy Ranged Weapons

Armor: All Armor

Hit Points: 1d8 per level.

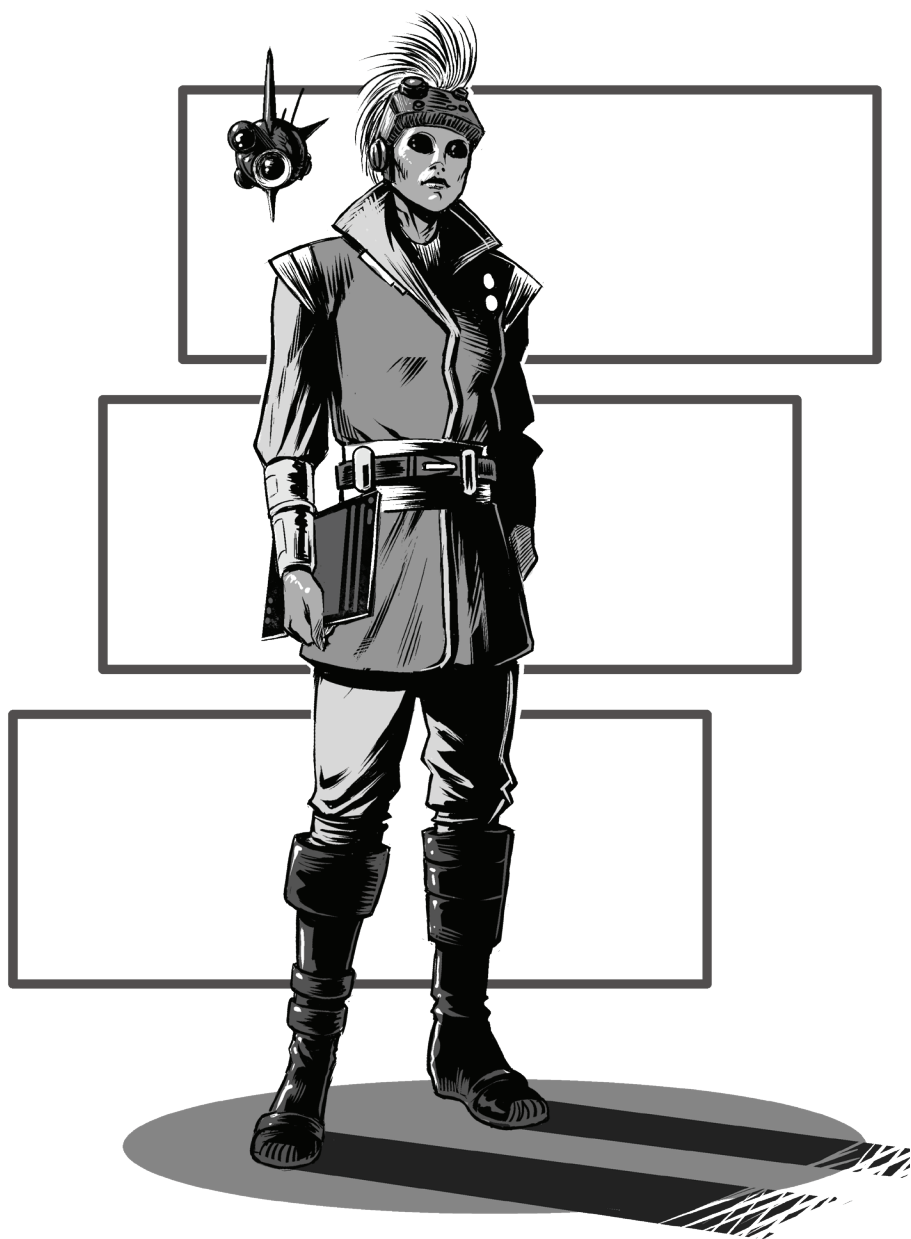
Sturdy. You gain +2 HP when making a Tough character. Roll additional hit points gained with advantage.

Resilient. You have advantage on CON checks to resist permanent injury, disease, toxins, or extreme environmental conditions.

Unyielding. 3/day, you can choose to make a DC 18 CON check (the Resilient talent applies) instead of a death roll. If you succeed, you get back up at 1 HP. The Death Timer still applies.

TOUGH TALENTS

2d6	Talent
2	Shake it Off. 1/day, ignore all damage and effects from one attack. If you already have Shake it Off, you gain an additional use per day.
3-5	+1 to melee or ranged attacks
6-9	+2 to either Str, Dex, Con
10-11	Choose one category of armor. You get +1 AC from that armor.
12	Choose a talent or +2 points to distribute to stats.



CLEVER ARCHETYPE

Scientists, hackers, strategists, and inventors. Clever characters use their intellect to see a variety of possibilities and think outside the box.

Weapons: Light Ranged Weapons

Armor: None

Hit Points: 1d4 per level.

Languages. You know two additional common languages and two rare languages.

Specialization. Choose one specific non-combat specialization that is tied to your background (ex. for the Medic background, you might choose battlefield triage). Add +1 to any rolls associated with that specialization. In addition, add half your level to these rolls (round down).

Keen Support. 3/day, when an ally is about to make a non-combat roll, make a DC 9 Intelligence check. If you succeed, they can add +1d4 to their roll.

CLEVER TALENTS

2d6 Talent

- | | |
|------|--|
| 2 | Improvise. 1/day, make an INT check to overcome a non-combat obstacle or problem instead of the expected stat check. If you already have Improvise, you gain an additional use per day. |
| 3-5 | Gain one additional use of Keen Support. |
| 6-8 | +2 to Intelligence stat or +1 to Specialization checks |
| 9-11 | Learn one additional Specialization. |
| 12 | Choose a talent or +2 points to distribute to stats. |

BACKGROUND

Your Background is as much a part of who you are as your Archetype and helps define what you are good at. Use the list below or create your own that best suits your Spacer. Make sure to discuss any new backgrounds with your GM.

You have advantage on checks in situations where your Background applies.

BACKGROUND

d20 Details

- 1 **Street Rat.** You know the merciless streets of cities and villainous hives.
- 2 **Outlaw.** You're a wanted criminal hiding from jail or worse.
- 3 **Hacker.** Datanets are no match for you.
- 4 **Operative.** You have crime syndicate connections, contacts, and debts.
- 5 **Roughneck.** Mining, hauling, or salvaging, you work best in extreme environments.
- 6 **Mechanic.** You can fix and tinker on a device or vehicle.
- 7 **Politician.** You navigate bureaucracy like some navigate the stars.
- 8 **Fence.** You can appraise value and know where to find a buyer.
- 9 **Gambler.** You never turn down a good bet.
- 10 **Corpo.** The ways of the corporate world are second nature to you.
- 11 **Mercenary.** You would fight friend and foe alike for your credits.
- 12 **Pilot.** Pirate, privateer, or merchant — the stars are yours.
- 13 **Acolyte.** You're well-trained in religious rites and doctrines.
- 14 **Soldier.** You serve as a fighter in an organized army.
- 15 **Ranger.** The frontier is your true home, surviving on stealth and wits.
- 16 **Scientist.** You seek discovery through experimentation rather than study.
- 17 **Celebrity.** You've traveled far with your charm and talent.
- 18 **Academic.** You seek discovery through study rather than experimentation.
- 19 **Noble.** A famous name has opened many doors for you.
- 20 **Medic.** You know anatomy, surgery, and first aid.

MOTIVATION

Motivations reflect a spacer's relationships with the universe's societal and hirearchical structures. These motivations influence character development and interactions. They are not static and can shift over time.

Each Motivation has a Starting Bonus that a spacer gains when first created and a Gameplay Effect that occurs when they act in accordance with their Motivation. A spacer's Motivation is not static and can change and evolve but they do not gain the Starting Bonus when this occurs.

THE SURVIVOR (S)

The harsh realities of hirearchical dominion and economic disparity have worn down survivors. They adapt, overcome, and do whatever is necessary to survive.

Starting Bonus: Roll on the Citizen Starting Equipment chart for an extra piece of gear.

Gameplay Effect: Receive a Luck Token when acting in a way that exemplifies resilience and adaptability.

THE VILE (VL)

Vile characters have embraced darker aspects such as ambition and greed. They might manipulate, betray, or take advantage of others by any means necessary.

Starting Bonus: You start with an extra 2d10 credits.

Gameplay Effect: Receive a Luck Token when acting in self-interest or engaging in morally dubious actions.

THE VIRTUOUS (VR)

Virtuous characters are guided by time-honored virtues such as courage, justice, and loyalty. They strive to act for the greater good, even in the face of personal sacrifice.

Starting Bonus: 1d3 trusted contacts. These can be defined before or during gameplay and will always assist your character if they are able to do so.

Gameplay Effect: Receive a Luck Token when engaging in actions that upholds your principles.

GEAR

CREDITS

DarkSpace simplifies currency to **credits**.

CredChits are physical credit tokens that can be deposited to a character's account. They occupy one gear slot per 100 CredChits.

1st level characters, or **Rookies** start with 2d6 x 10 credits.

STARTING GEAR

0-Level characters, or **Citizens**, start with 1d4 of the items on the Citizen Starting Gear table.

Rookie Spacers use their starting credits to purchase gear. **Rookies** can get started with a **Spacer's Kit** which contains the essentials for survival in the dark of space.

A Spacer's Kit costs 40cr. It uses 5 gear slots and contains the following items:

CITIZEN STARTING GEAR

D12	GEAR
1	Glowrod
2	Light Edged Weapon
3	Medkit
4	Light Projectile Pistol
5	Cable, Synthetic
6	Energy Cells (2)
7	Spacer's Multitool
8	Communicator
9	Rebreather
10	Grapple
11	Light Blunt Weapon
12	Rations (3 pack)

SPACER'S KIT

GEAR	GEAR SLOTS	COST
Backpack	Free	3cr
Cable, Synthetic	1	10cr
CredStick	Free	Free
Energy Cells (2)	1	10cr
Glowrod	1	10cr
Grapple	1	2cr
Rations (3 pack)	1	5cr

ITEM	COST	GEAR SLOT
Ammo Magazine	3cr	2 per slot
Backpack	3cr	1 (first one free to carry)
Cable, Polymer	20cr	1
Cable, Synthetic	10cr	1
Communicator*	20cr	1
CredStick	3cr	free to carry
Datapad*	50cr	1
Energy Cell	5cr	2 per slot
Glowrod*	10cr	1
Grapple	2cr	1
Medkit	20cr	1
Multitool	10cr	1
Ration Packs (3)	5cr	1
Rebreather*	20cr	1
Scanner, Handheld*	50cr	1
Security Kit	35cr	1
StimPak	10cr	2 per slot
Vision Enhancer	30cr	1

***EC (Energy Cell):** This device requires an energy cell to use, on a critical failure (natural one on 1d20 attack roll), the energy cell is exhausted and will need to be swapped out as an action.

GEAR DESCRIPTIONS

Ammo Magazine. Ammo for Projectile Weapons. Holds enough ammo until it doesn't. See **Am (Ammo)** weapon property for details.

Backpack. Holds your gear. If lost, your gear is lost.

Cable, Polymer. 60' long, space age polymer, 2,000 lb. tensile strength.

Cable, Synthetic. 60' long, synthetic fibers, 1,000 lb. tensile strength.

Communicator. EC, Planet-wide communication, configurable channels.

CredStick. A metallic pen-sized cylinder. Tracks your legal currency account, don't lose it.

Datapad. EC, A personal computation device used for accessing datanets and personal files.

Energy Cell (EC). Plasma-based energy storage used to power gear. Two per gear slot.

Glowrod. EC, sheds light up to Near distance. One Energy Cell lasts for one hour of real time.

Grapple. Hook and clip for latching onto objects, can be fired from projectile weapon.

Medkit. Kit with basic medical supplies. Grants advantage on stabilizing rolls for organic lifeforms.

Multitool. Compact toolbox with common tools. Used for mechanical repairs. Grants advantage on stabilizing rolls for androids.

Rations. Packaged food and water for one day. Comes in three-packs

that take up a gear slot.

Rebreather. EC, Personal self-contained breathing device. Can be upgraded for additional functionality. Rebreathers last for one hour of real time on a single EC.

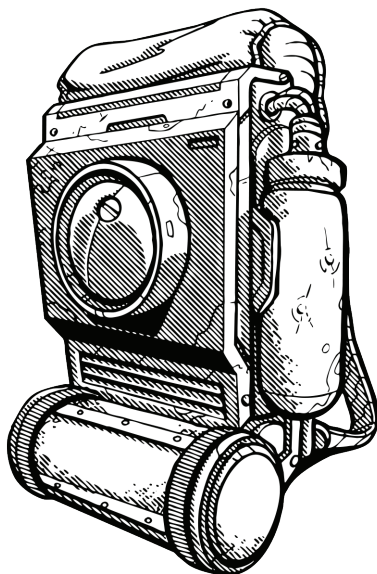
Scanner, Handheld. EC, A multipurpose diagnostic tool for detecting life signs, environmental data, and energy signatures.

Security Tools. Necessary for bypassing security controls.

StimPak. One-time use. Stabilize and heal 1d4 hp.

Vision Enhancer, Basic. A pair of binoculars.

Vision Enhancer, Advanced. EC, Handheld, computer-assisted vision in spectrum other than visible light.



ARMOR

ARMOR CATEGORIES

CATEGORY	COST	GEAR SLOTS	AC	PROPERTIES
Light Armor	25cr	1	11+ DEX mod	Ph
Medium Armor	50cr	2	13 + DEX Mod	Ph, Disadvantage on stealth & swim
Heavy Armor	75cr	3	15	Ph, Disadvantage on stealth, No swim
Energy Armor	100cr	1	15	EC, EN
Helmet	10cr	1	+1	Ph, Disadvantage on perception
Exosuit Conversion	+50cr	+1	-	Adds Rebreather and Radiation Resistance
Ballistic Shield	20cr	1	+2	1H, Ph
Energy Shield	30cr	0	+2	EC, 1H, EN

1H (One Handed): This armor occupies one hand.

EC (Energy Cell): This armor requires an energy cell to use, on a Critical Hit (20 on a 1d20 Attack Roll) against this armor, the energy cell is exhausted and will need to be swapped out as an action.

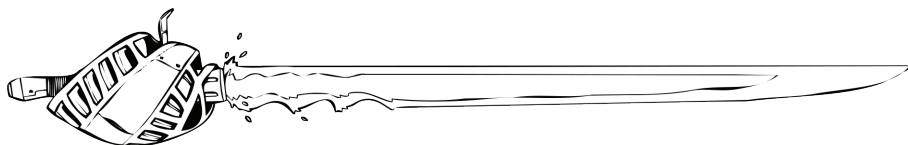
En (Energy Armor): Weapons with the Disabling (D) property affect this armor.

Ph (Physical Armor): Weapons with the Armor Piercing (AP) property ignore this armor.

MELEE WEAPONS

MELEE WEAPON CATEGORIES

CATEGORY	COST	RANGE	DAMAGE	PROPERTIES
Blunt, Light	1cr	C/N	1d4	Th
Blunt, Medium	3cr	C	1d6/1d8	V
Blunt, Heavy	5cr	C	1d10	2H
Force, Light	5cr	C/N	1d6	EC , Th
Force, Medium	10cr	C	1d8/1d10	EC , V
Force, Heavy	15cr	C	1d12	EC , 2H
Edged, Light	1cr	C/N	1d4	Th
Edged, Medium	3cr	C	1d6/1d8	V
Edged, Heavy	5cr	C	1d10	2H
Vibro, Light	5cr	C/N	1d6	EC , Th
Vibro, Medium	10cr	C	1d8/1d10	EC , V
Vibro, Heavy	15cr	C	1d12	EC , 2H
Stun Baton	15cr	C	Disabling (DC 9)	EC
Beam Saber	NA	C	1d12	EC , AP, light weapon



RANGED WEAPONS

PROJECTILE WEAPON CATEGORIES

CATEGORY	COST	RANGE	DAMAGE	PROPERTIES
Pistol, Light	5cr	N	1d4	Am
Pistol, Medium	10cr	N	1d6	Am
Pistol, Heavy	15cr	N	1d8	Am
Rifle, Light	20cr	F	1d4	Am, 2H
Rifle, Medium	25cr	F	1d6	Am, 2H
Rifle, Heavy	30cr	F	1d8	Am, 2H, R

DISABLING WEAPON CATEGORIES

CATEGORY	COST	RANGE	DAMAGE	PROPERTIES
Ion Pistol	30cr	N	Disabling (DC 12)	EC, D
Ion Rifle	50cr	F	Disabling (DC 15)	EC, D, 2H

ENERGY WEAPON CATEGORIES

CATEGORY	COST	RANGE	DAMAGE	PROPERTIES
Energy Pistol, Light	10cr	N	1d6	EC
Energy Pistol, Medium	25cr	N	1d8	EC
Energy Pistol, Heavy	50cr	N	1d10	EC, R
Energy Rifle, Light	25cr	F	1d6	EC, 2H
Energy Rifle, Med.	45cr	F	1d8	EC, 2H
Energy Rifle, Heavy	65cr	F	1d10	EC, AP, 2H, R

TALENTS / TRAITS

CHA

ATTACKS

LEVEL	XP

PLAYER	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30	31	32	33	34	35	36	37	38	39	40	41	42	43	44	45	46	47	48	49	50	51	52	53	54	55	56	57	58	59	60	61	62	63	64	65	66	67	68	69	70	71	72	73	74	75	76	77	78	79	80	81	82	83	84	85	86	87	88	89	90	91	92	93	94	95	96	97	98	99	100
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1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20
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**FREE TO
CARRY**